ANZ – Garland/Bouquet Seva

1. Purpose

- These guidelines will help volunteers prepare garlands/bouquets with bhakti, cleanliness, consistency, and care to offer to Bhagwan on a regular basis.

2. Duration

- **Commencement:** On Sunday, 4th October 2026, during Mahant Swami Maharaj's 93rd Janma Jayanti this special seva will begin.
- **Every Sunday:** Garlands or bouquets for Akshar Purushottam Maharaj (if applicable Ghanshyam Maharaj).
- **Mahotsav:** Garlands/bouquets for Akshar Purushottam Maharaj (if applicable Ghanshyam Maharaj), and extra garland/bouquet for mahotsav related murti (Mahotsav dates have been given in the SDC yearly planner).
- **Ekadashi:** Garlands/bouquets for Akshar Purushottam Maharaj (if applicable Ghanshyam Maharaj).
- **Guest:** For special events when garlands/bouquets are needed (Ex. Santo from India, VIP guest in sabha, etc.), Mandir Coordinator will inform the lead.

3. Location

- **Mandir/Home:** Garlands/Bouquets can be made by gathering at a Haribhakta's home or at mandir.

4. Volunteers

- **Volunteers:** Mahila mandal will be able to take part in the seva of making garlands/bouquets. If the number of volunteers increase, groups can be made to take part in the seva. (Discuss with Mandir Coordinator if groups need to be made.)
- **Centre:** Type A and B centres will participate in this project.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Pujari Lead:** Confirms requirements with the pujari, arranges supplies, and assigns volunteers. Communicates with mahila lead and offers support.
- **Mahila Lead:** Gathers the mahila team to make garlands/bouquets.

6. Weekly Schedule

- **3–4 days before:** Confirm the number, size, and style of garlands/bouquets required for the week.
- **1–2 days before:** Collect or purchase fresh flowers, thread, needles, and leaves.
- **Garland/Bouquet-making day:** Sort flowers, prepare the workspace, make garlands/bouquets, inspect quality, and store or deliver them as instructed.
- **After completion:** Clean the workspace, dispose of waste respectfully, and record any supply needs for the following week.

7. Materials

- Fresh, clean, fragrance-appropriate flowers such as jasmine, rose, marigold, chrysanthemum, or other flowers.
- Strong cotton or nylon thread, suitable needles, scissors, clean trays, clean cloths, and labelled containers.
- Avoid spoiled flowers, flowers with unpleasant smell, dyed or spray-painted flowers.
- Flowers can be picked from Haribhakta's homes. If flowers are not available from anyone's home, they can be purchased by the lead from the store.
    - Purchased flowers can be done in seva by a team member. If they need to be reimbursed for the purchase, then the receipt needs to be submitted to the accounts team within a week of the purchase.

8. Cleanliness

- Wash hands before handling flowers and rewash hands after breaks, cleaning, or touching non-flower items.
- Use clean trays, cloths, tools, and work surfaces only.
- Keep food, drinks, shoes, rubbish, and unrelated items away from the garland/bouquet-making area.
- While making the garland/bouquet volunteers may sing bhajans, listen to katha, do praptino vichar, etc.
- Do not place flowers or garlands/bouquets directly on the floor.

9. Storage and Delivery

- Keep garlands/bouquets cool, shaded, and away from strong smells until they are offered.
- If made ahead, store garlands/bouquets in a clean, covered container with a lightly damp cloth.
- Do not crush or tightly stack delicate garlands/bouquets.
- Deliver garlands /bouquets to the pujari at the agreed time.
- Once the garlands/bouquets are offered for one day, the prasadi garlands/bouquets can be given to a guest in sabha. If there are no guest in sabha, it can be given to Haribhakta who comes to mandir on a special occasion of their birthday, anniversary, car pujan, etc.